[1] In Morocco, each year thousands of young girls from poor families are sent to work in houses in the city. They are often ill-treated and exploited. No official numbers exist, but one non-governmental organization called Dari has counted 23,000 child maids in Casablanca alone.

[2] Halima is one of **them**. When she was 8 years old, her family sent her to Casablanca to work as a maid. Her father had some financial trouble, so he got in touch with an intermediary whose job was to find maids for rich families. The little girl agreed because she thought that she could be of some help to her parents. But being a maid was not what she really dreamed of. She worked all day long, slept in the kitchen, and was often beaten up by her host family. But she managed to escape from the house where she was working.

[3] Later, someone found her in the street all in tears and helpless, and took her to Dari. Thanks to Dari, Halima now lives at a shelter for former child maids where she is learning cooking and hairdressing. "For the first time since I was 8, I have finally found a place to rest," Halima said.

[4] Dari's director says: "The majority of child maids come from the countryside where most families have little money and a lot of kids. If they send a girl away to work as a domestic, that means an important source of income and one less mouth to feed. The parents think that they are doing something nice for their daughters, saving them from the harsh conditions in the countryside, and hoping for a better future for them. But child maids often end up suffering twice: as kids and as adults. When they grow up, they are often exploited by crime gangs".

[5] Dari's director further explains that their association works to educate poor parents about the reality of child maids and their exploitation. **It** also runs programs to sensitize the wealthy families to the rights of their maids: fair treatment, good pay, and basic education.

[6] This issue of child maids is now being addressed by many civil associations. The abuses are being exposed on TV, and more voices are heard against employing child maids, believing that all children should have the right to enjoy their childhood and get a proper education.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

BASE ALL YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT.

A. ARE THESE SENTENCES TRUE OR FALSE? JUSTIFY. (3 pts)

1. Halima started working as a maid at an early age.

……

2. Parents expect their daughters to have a better life in the city.

……

3. The abuses of child maids are completely ignored by the media now.

……

B. ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS. (3 pts)

1. Why did Halima accept to work as a maid?

……

2. How was Halima treated by her host family?

……

3. What rights should children have according to the media?

……

C. FILL IN THE CHART WITH THE RIGHT INFORMATION FROM THE TEXT. (2 pts)

People concerned	Assistance given to them by Dari
Child maids	give shelter to former child maids/ teach them cooking and hairdressing
poor parents	…… ……
wealthy families	……
	……

D. COMPLETE THESE SENTENCES. (2 pts)

1. Because they are poor, parents in the countryside …….

……

2. When child maids get older, they are often ……

……

E. FIND IN THE TEXT WORDS THAT MEAN ALMOST THE SAME AS: (3 pts)

1. run away (paragraph 2): ……
2. relax (paragraph 3): ……
3. severe (paragraph 4): ……

F. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS IN THE TEXT REFER TO? (2 pts)

1. them: ……
2. it: ……

A. FILL IN EACH GAP WITH AN APPROPRIATE WORD FROM THE LIST. (3 pts)

formal - defend - achievement - prevent - agreement - global

1. We should do our best to ……..…… people from employing children.

2. Many world leaders attended last year's conference on ……..…..…… warming.

3. Hind's parents are satisfied with her ……..…..…… at school.

B. REWRITE THE SENTENCES BEGINNING WITH THE WORDS GIVEN. (4 pts)

1. "I have already read that novel," Rebecca said.

Rebecca said ……..……..……..

2. Mr Parker was poor; however, he managed to educate his kids well.

Despite ……..……..…….

3. Emma didn't save enough money; she couldn't buy a computer.

If Emma ……..……..

4. The local council will build a new school in our area.

A new school ……..……..……

C. PUT THE VERBS BETWEEN BRACKETS IN THE CORRECT TENSE. (3 pts)

In a press conference, the president of El Amal Association said: "Last October, we (start)…..……..… a project to fight illiteracy. We (work) ……..……with the ministry of education on the same project since then. I guess, by the year 2016, we (achieve)……..…… our goals."

D. MATCH EACH STATEMENT WITH ITS APPROPRIATE FUNCTION. (4pts)

EXPRESSIONS	FUNCTIONS
1. "In my view, parents are too tolerant with their kids," Harry told his classmates.	a. purpose
2. Brain drain refers to the emigration of educated and skilled people.	b. opinion
3. Computers are used not only for learning but also for entertainment.	c. defining
4. "Our team trained hard so as to be ready for the final match," the coach said.	d. addition

1. . . . . 2 . . . . .. 3 . . . . . 4 . . . .

E. FILL IN EACH GAP WITH AN APPROPRIATE WORD FROM THE LIST. (1 pt; 0.5 pt each)

place - care - taking - fun - solving

1. Some students have problems with note ……..…….. techniques.

2. Betty always takes ……..… of her little sister when her mother is busy**.**

WRITING (10 POINTS)

Write an email to your friend telling him / her about what you do in your free time.

(Approximately 200 words)

These cues may help you:

- play computer game, watch TV, practice sports, - entertain/enjoy oneself
- listen to music, surf the Internet, etc... - get information(Internet)
- have a wonderful time with friends - gain experience
- relax /…….. - keep fit

……

……

……

KEY AND MARKING SCALE

Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

Testees should not be penalised for spelling or grammar mistakes in the comprehension section.

TRUE / FALSE: (3 pts)

1. **True.** "When she was 8 years old, her family sent her to Casablanca to work as a maid." (paragraph 2)
2. **True.** The parents are "hoping for a better future for them". (paragraph 4)
3. **False.** "The abuses are being exposed on TV" (paragraph 6)

WH QUESTIONS: (3 pts)

1. Because she thought that she could be of some help to her parents.
2. She worked all day long, slept in the kitchen, and was often beaten up.
3. The right to enjoy their childhood and get a proper education.

CHART FILLING: (2 pts)

Poor parents: educate them about the reality of child maids and their exploitation
Wealthy families: sensitize them to the rights of their maids (fair treatment, good pay, basic education)

SENTENCE COMPLETION: (2 pts)

1. ...send their girls away to work as domestics (for an important source of income and one less mouth to feed).
2. ...exploited by crime gangs.

RIGHT WORD MEANING: (3 pts) 1. escape 2. rest 3. harsh

WORD REFERENCE: (2 pts) 1. Child maids (young girls from poor families) 2. Dari (the association)

II. LANGUAGE (15 POINTS)

GAP FILLING: (3 pts) 1. prevent 2. global 3. achievement

REWRITING SENTENCES: (4 pts)

1. Rebecca said **(that) she had already read that novel**.
2. Despite **being poor, Mr Parker managed to educate his kids well**.
3. If Emma **had saved enough money, she could have bought a computer**.
4. A new school **will be built in our area by the local council**.

VERB TENSES: (3 pts)

1. started (past simple)
2. have been working (present perfect continuous)
3. will have achieved (future perfect)

MATCHING: (4 pts) 1. b. opinion 2. c. defining 3. d. addition 4. a. purpose

GAP FILLING: (1 pt) 1. taking 2. care

III. WRITING (10 POINTS; task 1: 4 pts; task 2: 6 pts)

The following criteria should be respected while scoring the writing tasks.

Scoring criteria	Task 1	Task 2
Relevance of content to the task	2 pts	3 pts
Appropriateness and variety of vocabulary	1 pt	2 pts
Grammar and mechanics	1 pt	1 pt

Model answers (any appropriate answer is accepted)

Writing: Write an email to your friend telling him/her about what you do in your free time. (Approximately 200 words): Subject: My free time Dear Jack, How are you? I hope everything is fine. You asked me about my free time, so here is my answer. I don't have much free time during the week because of my studies, but I try to enjoy myself at the weekend. On Saturday mornings, I usually practice sports: I play football with my friends to keep fit, and it helps me relax after a hard week. In the afternoon, I like listening to music and watching a good film on TV. I also surf the Internet to get information about my hobbies and to chat with friends from other countries, which gives me a chance to practice my English. On Sundays, I often go out with my friends. We have a wonderful time together, and I think it gives me experience in how to deal with people. Sometimes I play computer games, but not for too long because I don't want to waste my time. What about you? What do you do in your free time? Write back soon. Best wishes, Yassine